Onboarding: ADS host environment

Nov/2025

Pre-requirements

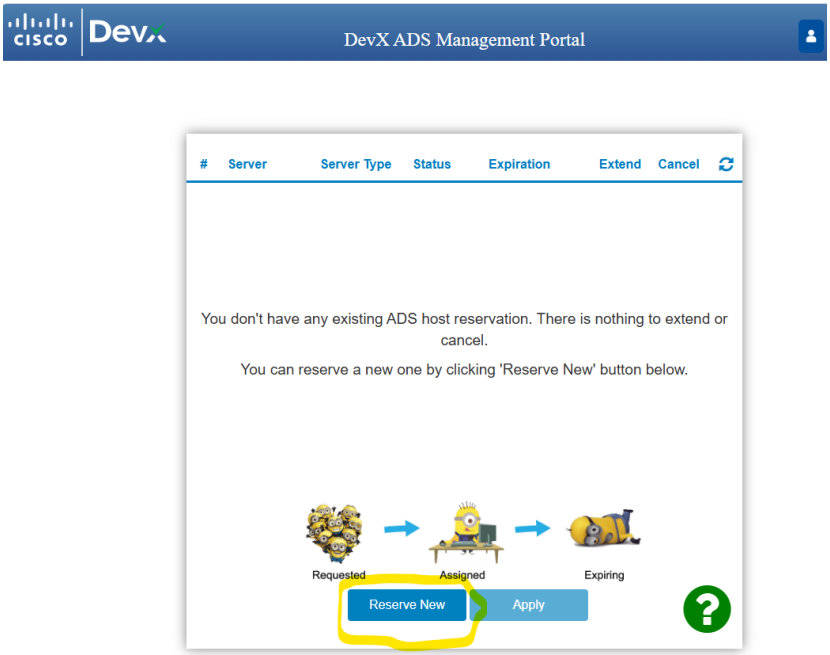
- Your Cisco **account** activated.
- Cisco laptop with **DUO authentication** working and **VPN connected**.
- **Webex** and **MS Outlook** applications.

There are two options to allocate an ADS host environment: DevX (legacy?) and RMS. Both require certain access rights assigned to your account, so it might be a blocker for your onboarding. This document outlines the general sequence of actions and how to request for help in case of problems and resolve it faster.

1. DevX ADS Management Portal

https://adsrsvp.cisco.com/#/adsman

Reserve an ADS provisional host. It should take less than 5 minutes to have the host allocated in just two steps:



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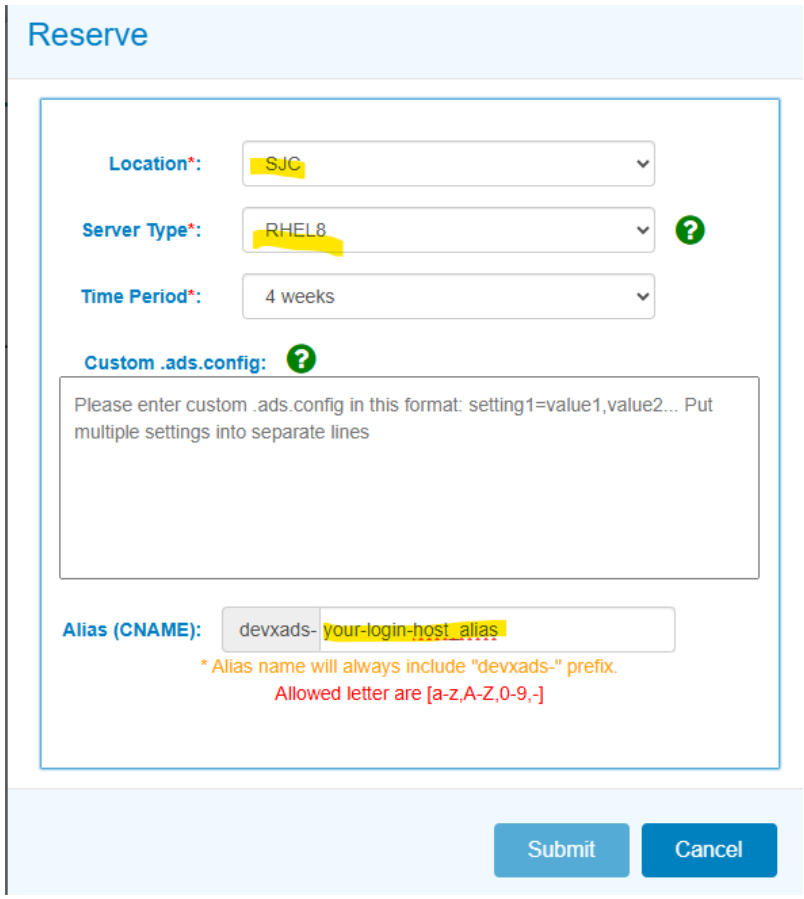

Alias can be any name as you wish.

Try to connect a SSH client to the ADS host from your Cisco laptop (VPN needs to be already connected). In case of success, you will see something like below:

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```
                              WARNING!!!
                    READ THIS BEFORE ATTEMPTING TO LOGON

      This System is for the use of authorized users only.  Individuals
      using this computer without authority, or in excess of their
      authority, are subject to having all of their activities on this
      system monitored and recorded by system personnel.  In the course
      of monitoring individuals improperly using this system, or in the
      course of system maintenance, the activities of authorized users
      may also be monitored.  Anyone using this system expressly
      consents to such monitoring and is advised that if such
      monitoring reveals possible criminal activity, system personnel
      may provide the evidence of such monitoring to law enforcement
      officials.

      Cisco Acceptable Use Policy:
      http://wwwin.cisco.com/c/cec/organizations/security-trust/infosec/policies.html

        ============================================================
              NOTE: SSH ON THIS DEVICE USES DUO
                    1. Enter CEC Password at Password prompt
                    2. Authenticate using DUO
              FAQ: https://unixauth.cisco.com
        ============================================================


      ##############################################################################
      Access is restricted!

      This host has been placed under REALM control as a member of the bundle(s):
      INS-SW-BUILD
      CN-NX-BUILD
      MDS-BUILD
      MIGBU-XR-REALM
      IOS-XE-REALM-2

      If you require access to this host you can contact the bundle owner by going
      to https://realm.cisco.com/#!/assets-search and putting the name above in
      the Bundle Name field then click the Request Access button.

      more details can be found at: https://realm.cisco.com
      ##############################################################################
([redacted]@sjc-ads-1921) This is your AD password:
([redacted]@sjc-ads-1921) Duo two-factor login for [redacted]

Enter a passcode or select one of the following options:

 1. Duo Push to [redacted]

Passcode or option (1-1):
Success. Logging you in...
Last login: Tue Nov 25 05:53:09 2025
sjc-ads-1921:~ >
```

Possible problems:

You entered your AD password 3 times, it failed, and there was no prompt to enter a passcode or other authentication options. Assuming you enter the correct password, and your 2FA authentication works, it might be just because your account actually has no access to the REALM bundles associated with the ADS host as described by the SSH login message, so you need to request access group membership at the appropriate REALM bundle(s) listed in the message as described there. The separate section of this guide provides some details on the procedure.

Enter 1 at "Passcode or option (1-1):", then it will ask for the authentication through Duo Mobile app. It should be approved.

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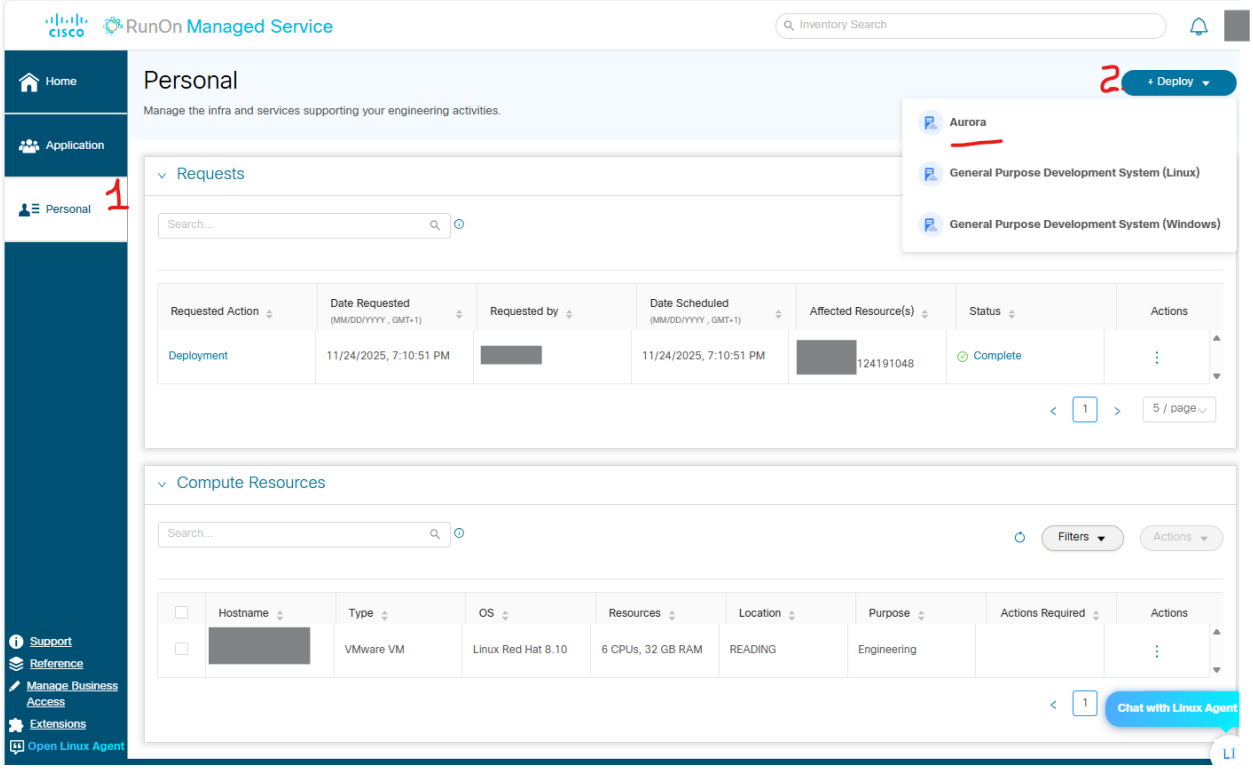
2. RunOn Managed Service (RMS)

https://managed.cisco.com/

At 'Personal', select 'Aurora' from 'Deploy' options:



The screenshot shows one request already completed and an active resource as an example. At first, there should be no requests and resources.

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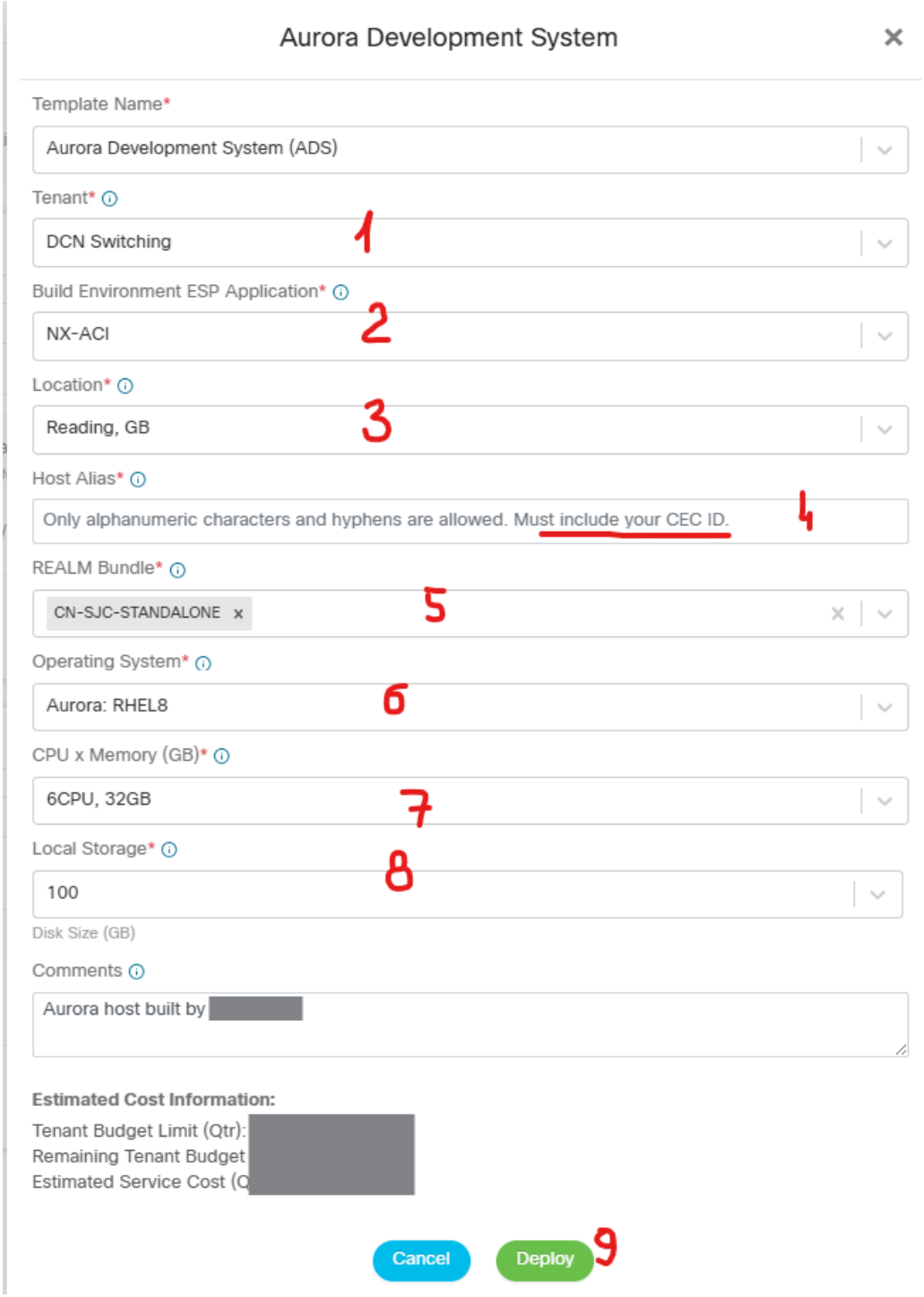
Fill out the deployment request form:



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1. Choose a ‘Tenant’ from available options.
   If this list is empty, or the required entry is missing, ask your manager to give you access permissions.
2. Choose ESP Application from the list.
3. Choose the best location from the list: either closer to your geo, or closer to other hosts/services you need to work with.
4. Enter an alias name for the host as described in the prompt.
5. Choose a REALM bundle.
   If the list is empty, or it miss the bundle needed, you should request access for group membership at the appropriate REALM bundle as described in the section below.
6. Choose OS you need.
7. Options depend on the ‘Location’ selected.
8. Options depend on the ‘Location’ selected.

Finally, check the remaining ‘Tenant Budget’ estimation, and press ‘Deploy’.

The deployment process might take several hours, and its status can be traced until ‘Complete’ is reached. You should also receive an email message “**REALM: Host deployed to bundle notification.”** with the ADS host name.

Try to connect a SSH client to the ADS host from your Cisco laptop (VPN needs to be already connected) as described earlier at the DevX ADS section.

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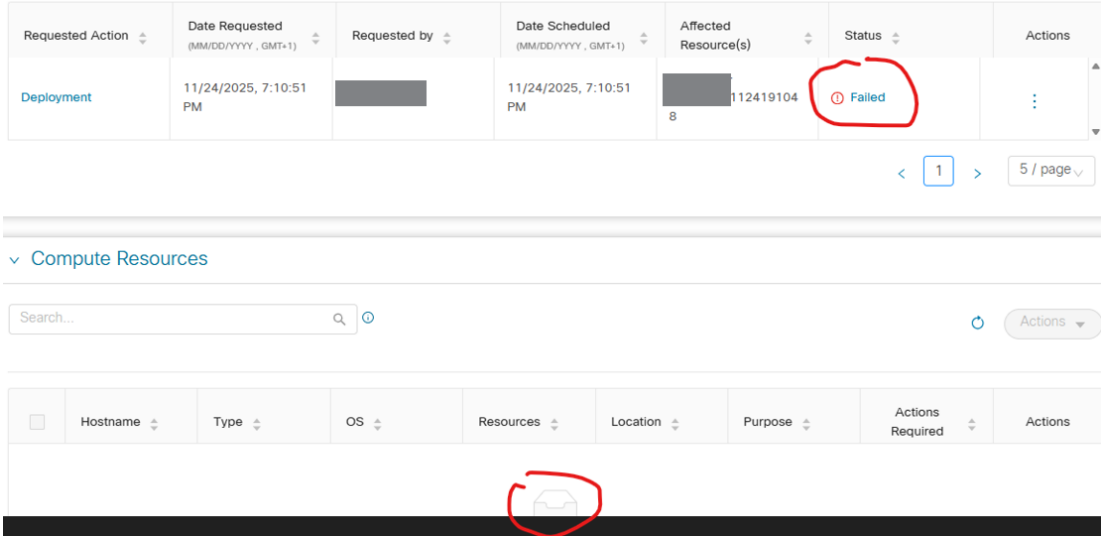
Possible problems:

The Deployment process failed, and no Compute Resource allocated:



For example, you might get an email notification:

```
"Message from helper "podman":
ERROR: Unable to access HOME directory …
cannot perform rootless-setup"
```

Contact Aurora support at http://ays.cisco.com/aurora

Most likely this kind of problem needs direct support from RMS on-call available at Webex "Linux RMS Support Room"
webexteams://im?space=9b59c100-976f-11f0-a03d-65fbd1764d98

Refer to your deployment Request ID shown in the 'Deployment' entry properties, for example:

Request ID
81aa21a4-cf00-4fe6-842d-08d53561cb68

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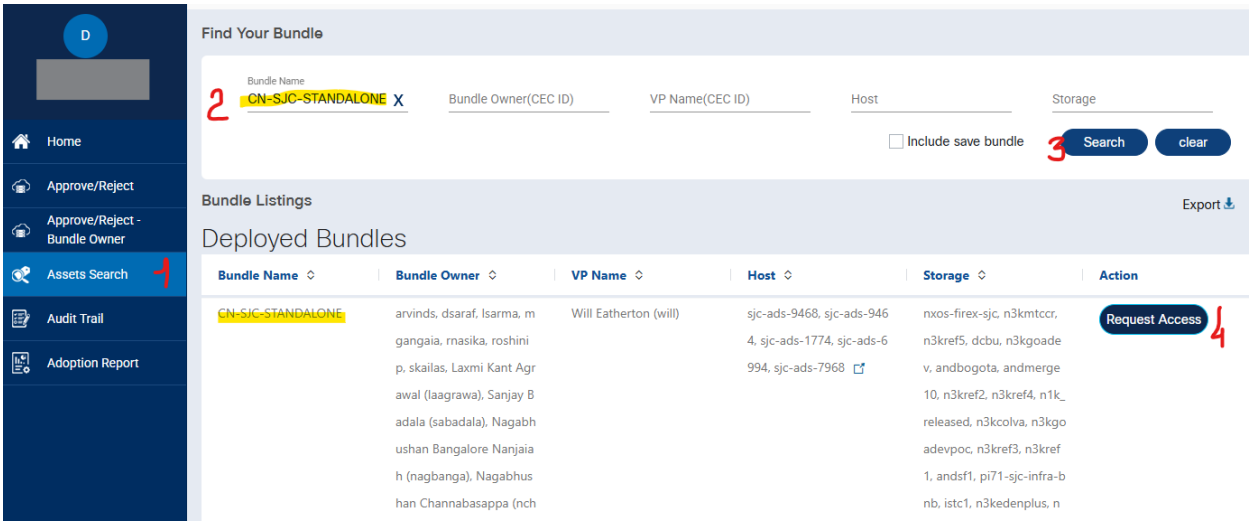
Request access to the REALM bundle

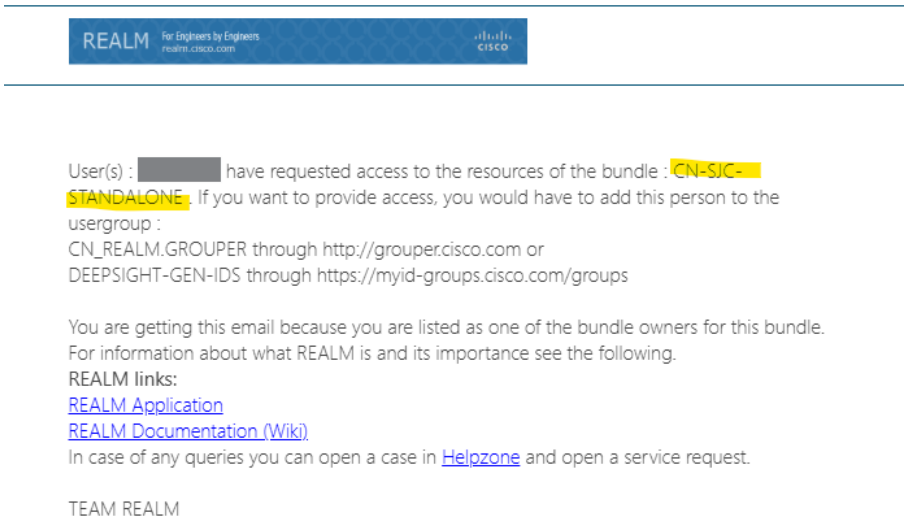
If you have no required REALM bundle available to select for the ADS Deployment, you should request it using "REALM Tool" *https://realm.cisco.com/*

Search for the REALM bundle and request access:



Possible problems:

An email is sent to the Bundle owners (and to you) that there are group membership missing:



You should contact the Realm owners directly for approvals.
In case you need **CN_REALM.GROUPER** membership raise service request to the **REALM team** at Helpzone and/or Webex "REALM Live Support'
webexteams://im?space=4c38e510-8707-11eb-8027-51d50df29a82

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